



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Here's what happened!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- How do you feel on the first day of a new job? Excited? Nervous?
- Do you find it nerve-racking?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can talk or report about actions, events or people.
- I can say what I was doing when something else happened.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa suggests that Sally does a **survey*** about ice cream. What do you think?

* A "survey" is when you ask people's opinions on a topic, and then present the results.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Well, my first day was a bit nerve-wracking. I'll have a steep learning curve, that's for sure.
- Vanessa:** What do you mean?
- Sally:** Well, everything was going well until I started talking about my new story ideas.
- Vanessa:** I'm sure you have lots of great story ideas.
- Sally:** I was thinking about doing an article on types of ice cream at the new ice cream parlour, but my editor told me that wasn't a good idea.
- Vanessa:** Why not?
- Sally:** She said we can't promote one particular business.
- Vanessa:** I can understand that.
- Sally:** Then I was considering a story about people's favorite ice cream, but then I remembered they asked me to write about different jobs.
- Vanessa:** Why don't you do a survey about people's favorite ice cream, and make a connection to their jobs? For example, you could find out what the favorite ice cream of lawyers, dentists, physicians or secretaries is.
- Sally:** Hmmm ... I'll think about it.



Let's Practice!

How was Sally's first day at the magazine?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Fill in the blank with the missing word. Use the past tense of each verb.

1. is: The first day _____ nerve-wracking.
2. start: Sally _____ yesterday.
3. tell: She _____ her editor about a story.
4. say: The editor _____ it was a good idea.
5. remember: Sally _____ something important.
6. ask: Her editor _____ her to write about jobs.



Let's Practice!

Everything was going well until ...

Instructions: Write the words in the correct category.

Past Continuous Tense

Past Tense

- Everything was going well ...
- ... but my editor told me that wasn't a good idea.
- I was thinking about doing an article on types of ice cream ...
- ... until I started talking about new story ideas.
- I was considering a story about people's favorite ice cream ...
- ... but then I remembered they asked me to write about different jobs.



Extension Activity

Collect stories about the first day of a new job.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Ask 5 people what happened to them on the first day of a new job. Try to find stories that are interesting or funny.
- Ask questions to get more details.
- Ask each person how they felt about the experience.
- Write the answers on a list.
- Present the most interesting story to your classmates.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I talk to 5 people.

☐ ☐

I write a list of stories.

☐ ☐

I present 1 story to the class.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **nerve-wracking** (adjective): difficult; stressful
e.g. My first day on the job was a bit nerve-wracking.
- **learning curve** (noun): the amount you need to learn, described like a graph
e.g. I'll have a steep learning curve, that's for sure.
- **editor** (noun): the person responsible for deciding on the content of publications like newspapers or magazines
Example: My editor told me it wasn't a good idea.
- **lawyer** (noun): a person who defends people in the legal system, or tries to prove they are guilty of a crime
Example: Working as a lawyer is difficult.
- **dentist** (noun): a person who cares for teeth
e.g. It takes many years of education to become a dentist.
- **secretary** (noun): a person who assists with a variety of office tasks
e.g. Secretaries are very important in an organization.
- **physician** (noun): medical doctor
Example: Our city needs more physicians.





Learning Points

Simple Past Tense versus Past Continuous Tense

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about events that are finished. You use the Past Continuous to talk about an event or action that was happening at a time in the past.

Simple Past tense verbs can be regular or irregular.

Regular verbs end in *-ed* or *-ied*.

Irregular verbs change in different ways. (e.g. *have* → *had*, *eat* → *ate*)

For the Past Continuous tense, you write *was/were* + verb + *ing*.

Some verbs need a change to the last letter before you add *-ing*. (e.g. *run* → *running*, *make* → *making*)

Present	Past	Past Continuous
talk	talked	was/were talking
get	got	was/were getting
fly	flew	was/were flying
work	worked	was/were working
discuss	discussed	was/were discussing
enjoy	enjoyed	was/were enjoying

Examples:

- I **was thinking** about doing an article on types of ice cream. (**Past Continuous**)
- My editor **told** me that wasn't a good idea. (**Simple Past**)
- I **was considering** a story about people's favorite ice cream. (**Past Continuous**)
- Then I **remembered** they asked me to write about different jobs. (**Simple Past**)

